



△ Sword from the court of Suleiman the Magnificent

1526

OTTOMAN ARMIES INVADE EUROPE

Ottoman sultan from 1520, Suleiman the Magnificent launched a series of campaigns against Christian Europe. In 1526, his invading army crushed the Hungarians at Mohacs, bringing his forces to the border of Austria. Three years later, he besieged the Austrian capital, Vienna. The city held out and Europe remained resistant to the spread of Islam.

▽ Henry VIII, portrait by Hans Holbein



1534

HENRY VIII BREAKS WITH ROME

Angered by the refusal of Pope Clement VII to annul his marriage to Catherine of Aragon, English King Henry VIII declared himself head of the Church of England, renouncing papal authority. Over following years monasteries were broken up and church lands confiscated by the Crown. Stubborn opponents of religious reform, such as Henry's former chancellor Thomas More, were executed.

1527 Protestant
German soldiers
plunder the holy city
of Rome

1533 Inca ruler
Atahualpa is captured
and executed by
Spanish Conquistadores

1534 Ignatius Loyola
creates the Society of
Jesus (the Jesuits) to
spread the Catholic faith

1539

1534 Breton mariner
Jacques Cartier begins
exploring the St Lawrence
River in North America

"I who am the Sultan of Sultans,
the Shadow of God upon Earth..."

SULTAN SULEIMAN THE MAGNIFICENT

1522-1791

CHINA'S FOUR CLASSIC NOVELS

Printing allowed the cheap production of novels in book form, making them popular in Ming China. The best known are the "Four Classic Novels".



1522 *Romance of the Three Kingdoms* was written by Luo Guanzhong before 1400 and printed in 1522 (painted scene above).



1589 The roguish characters in the vivid Ming folk tales of *The Water Margin* made the book very popular when it was printed in 1589.



1592 *Journey to the West*, written by Wu Cheng'en, is most famous for the antics of the mischievous Monkey King (pictured above).



1791 In *Dream of the Red Chamber*, Qing era writer Cao Xueqin uses the story of an elite family to probe society.